OnRamps 2026 – Project Plan

From Passion to Product: Creating AI Solutions with Microsoft AI

Students will explore how artificial intelligence can be used to design meaningful, useful, and impactful solutions. By leveraging Microsoft AI products, students will gain hands-on experience building intelligent systems that can reason, assist, and automate real-world tasks.

Focus

- Learn foundational concepts in Generative AI, Microsoft Copilot, and AI solutions
- Build and experiment with simple AI solutions using Microsoft Copilot
- Research real-world problems aligned with personal passions
- Design and prototype an AI agent-based solution
- Develop and refine agent behaviors, prompts, and workflows
- Contribute to a team GitHub repository
- Present their solution during a capstone showcase

Solution Flexibility & Technology Approach

Students are not restricted to a specific technology stack when developing their AI agent solutions. Solutions can be built using any approach or combination of tools. The only requirement is that the solution leverages Microsoft products, platforms, or Copilot capabilities. Students are encouraged to explore options including Microsoft 365 Copilot solutions, Copilot Studio, Power Platform, Azure AI services, and integrations with external data or services. The focus of this project is problem-solving and solution design, not adherence to a specific technical implementation.

Final Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
AI & Agent Fundamentals Research (README)	A 1–2 page README explaining Generative AI, Microsoft Copilot, and AI solutions, including real-world use cases
Problem Research (README)	A README defining a real-world problem aligned to student passion and identifying the target user
Agent Solution Design (Architecture Overview)	A document outlining the agent's purpose, users, functionality, inputs, outputs, and value
Working AI Agent Solution	A functional agent built using Microsoft Copilot or Microsoft tools, addressing the chosen problem
Agent Documentation	README describing how the agent was designed, tested, and improved, including lessons learned
GitHub Contribution	Individual or team project folder with all artifacts, submitted to the team repository
Final Presentation and Demo	Team presentation showcasing individual research, solution, impact, and a live demo of the agent

6-Week Project Timeline

Week	Focus	Purpose & Deliverables
Week 1	AI Foundations & Copilot Upskilling	Intern onboarding, tool setup, introduction to Generative AI, Microsoft Copilot, and AI solutions. Build a simple agent using Copilot.
Week 2	AI & Agent Research	Submit README explaining Generative AI, prompt engineering, Copilot, and AI solutions with real-world use cases.
Week 3	Problem Research & Ideation	Identify a passion-driven problem and define how an AI agent could solve it. Submit problem + solution concept.
Week 4	Agent Development	Build and test an AI agent using Microsoft Copilot or other Microsoft tools. Begin documentation.
Week 5	Refinement & Presentation Prep	Improve agent functionality, test edge cases, finalize documentation, and prepare presentation.
Week 6	Showcase & Delivery	Present final solution, demo agent, and submit all deliverables.

Skills You Will Gain

- **Generative AI & Solutions**: Understand how AI models and solutions reason, act, and assist users
- **Microsoft Copilot**: Build and use AI solutions within the Microsoft ecosystem
- **Prompt Engineering**: Craft and refine prompts to guide AI behavior effectively
- **Technical Research**: Explore AI concepts and real-world applications
- **Solution Architecture**: Design systems that solve real problems using AI
- **Documentation & GitHub**: Organize and publish technical work professionally
- **Presentation Skills**: Communicate solutions clearly and confidently
- **Collaboration**: Work individually and as part of a team